Where the name came from

The word "nomadology" has more roots than the nomads. In Greek, the pasture came before both the law and any people, and Deleuze took his nomos from that philology in 1968, long before the steppe. Even the pasture has a prehistory, since the Bronze Age palaces counted and sorted flocks before Homer's open grazing. In *A Thousand Plateaus* the word first names a lack, and later what monadology turns into once its units open. Each row gives a source and what the word named there, along with what it brings to the name.

	When	Where	What the word names	What it brings to the name
A	Bronze Age	Linear B, Knossos and Pylos (Zartaloudis 122-31)	Flocks the palaces counted by place, shepherd, sign and number, often under a "collector," with rams castrated for "more homogeneous fleeces" 122	The undivided pasture is no origin before the State. In Zartaloudis's account it follows the palaces' administered flocks, once their collapse freed land for grazing 125. The collector's word, *a-ko-ra*, a gathering of flocks, later names the assembly, the agora 129-30
B	Homer	Laroche 1949 115-17	*Nomós*, the pasture: "un espace illimité" ("an unlimited space"), a forest, river meadows, a mountainside, and for humans "a habitat without recognized limits"	A distribution of herds across a space no one divides. Only from the fifth century B.C. was the word brought close to *némō*, "to share" 115. The two words, *nomós* and *nómos*, were later told apart by accent (Zartaloudis xxvii)
C	Hesiod to Attic Greek	Laroche 166, 196	*Nómos*, in which the musical, religious, moral and political senses "appear at once"	Music is as old as law in the word, and laws were sung before they were written. The early lawgivers called theirs *thesmoi*, not *nómoi* (Zartaloudis 387-90). Law, and "scientific law" (nomology), is the later, narrowed sense 196
D	Plato, *Statesman* 266e	Laroche 118-19	*Nomeús*, the distributor, becomes a title of the king, the "shepherd of peoples," and law is what grazes the human herd	Philosophers turned a word for pasture into a word for rule. A pasture tax belongs to the same family 118. In Homer, "shepherd of the people" is not yet a political title (Zartaloudis 139)
E	Pindar, Herodotus	Laroche 121	*Nomádes*, said of the Libyans, is "an adjective" that names "a way of life, not a nation"	The name of a people is the later form. The older one names a way of grazing, dwelling and spreading out
F	Schmitt, 1950 and 1953	*The Nomos of the Earth* 70, 324-26	Nomos as "the initial measure and division of pastureland," with "to take" (*nehmen*) as the first meaning of *nemein*	Schmitt cites Laroche and sets the philology aside 324 n. 1, so taking comes first by a jurist's choice, not by etymology. His nomos also rests on a contested Homeric reading, *nómon* for *noon* at *Odyssey* 1.3, which is carved on his tombstone (Zartaloudis 117-18)
G	Deleuze, 1968	*Difference and Repetition* 36-37 and n. 6	A "nomadic distribution," a nomos "without property, enclosure or measure," taken from Laroche	The word enters Deleuze's philosophy as a way of distributing being, twelve years before any steppe peoples appear in it. The word can only be *nomós*, the pasture, though Deleuze never marks the accent (Zartaloudis 141)
H	Deleuze, 1972	"Nomad Thought" 146-49	Nomadism as "a perpetual displacement in the intensities," and a nomad who "is not necessarily one who moves"	A thought set against philosophy, which "is born out of the imperial state" and stays tied to law 148
I	*A Thousand Plateaus*, 1980	Plateau 1 23	"What is lacking is a Nomadology, the opposite of a history," because history is written "from the sedentary point of view"	The word first names something missing
J		Plateau 3 43	One of seven names Professor Challenger gives his discipline, beside rhizomatics, stratoanalysis, schizoanalysis, micropolitics, pragmatics and the science of multiplicities	The name is one alias among others, and a joke: "no one clearly understood" the discipline's goals or method
K		Plateau 12 351-423	"Treatise on Nomadology," where the war machine is given to the nomads "only in the historical interest of demonstrating" that it was invented 422	Here the plateau withdraws the people its title seems to name
L		Plateau 14 494, 574 n. 27	After Châtelet on Riemann, monads "no longer thought to be closed upon themselves," linked "step-by-step," so that monadology "should be superseded by a 'nomadology'"	A second root, with no people in it: units opened and linked locally. *Nomad* is also an anagram of *monad*
M	1986	Semiotext(e)	*Nomadology: The War Machine*, plateau 12 printed alone in English	In English, the booklet cut the treatise off from plateau 13 and from the monad note. It became the English reception's text
N	Deleuze, 1988	*The Fold* 137	Monads "kept half open as if by a pair of pliers," held in "transitory captures," in habitats that "overtake monadology with a 'nomadology'"	Here is the opened monad again, now with capture in the same passage
O	1993 to 2019	Miller, Braidotti, Bogue, Zartaloudis	Miller traces the nomads to the colonial anthropology in the notes. Braidotti makes the nomad a figure of the subject. Bogue defends a "bastard concept." Zartaloudis finds the pairing of nomad and settled idealizing and historically imprecise 142 n. 48	The quarrel over the word is mostly a quarrel over the peoples it seems to name

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Approaches that come close

Several approaches outside Deleuze and Guattari's orbit come close to nomadology. Rather than grade them, each row ends on the question that would turn its concept toward a nomadology. The letters point to the roots on the front page, and the numbers to the guiding problems on the back of the sheet on royal and nomad science.

Concept	Works	Where it comes close	Root	Problem	The question it opens
Pastoral power	Foucault, *Security, Territory, Population* (1977-78 lectures)	A power exercised "not over a territory" but over "the flock in its movement" (125, cited in Zartaloudis 139), caring for each one and for all together. It starts where nomadology starts, from a multiplicity on the move	D	3, 6	*When a power tends a flock on the move, each one and all together, is the flock composed by its own movement or by the shepherd's count?*
Nomos as use	Zartaloudis, *The Birth of Nomos* (2019)	Nomos as a field of coexisting uses that jurists later projected back as law. A nomos, following Hirzel, is "a power that is; not a power that is 'had'" (xxxvii)	B, F	1	*If nomos was first a way of life, what had to be converted before it could be presented as a law that was always there?*
Nomos as appropriation	Schmitt, *The Nomos of the Earth* (1950)	The same word, and the question of how the earth is ordered, with taking first, dividing second and pasture last	F	1, 7	*When an order dates itself from an act of taking, what does it make of the life that came before it?*
Legibility	Scott, *Seeing Like a State* (1998), *The Art of Not Being Governed* (2009)	Counting as the way a State makes a population legible, against local measures, and peoples who live beyond the reach of the count	A	3	*When flight is told as an escape from the State's count, how does the fleeing body count itself?*
Silences	Trouillot, *Silencing the Past* (1995)	Power enters the record at every stage, from the making of sources to the making of narratives	A, F	1	*When an archive is made by the power it records, what does that power present as its own invention?*
Linkages	Wolf, *Europe and the People without History* (1982)	"Wide-ranging linkages among populations" before European expansion (25), against a world of bounded societies spinning off each other like "billiard balls" (6)	E	4	*What moves between formations without belonging to any one of them?*
Seasonal variation	Graeber and Wengrow, *The Dawn of Everything* (2021)	Societies that changed their social form with the seasons, taking on a hierarchy for part of the year and setting it down again	E	2	*When a society takes on a hierarchy for one season, what keeps the season from becoming a change in kind?*
Dependence on the outside	Khazanov, *Nomads and the Outside World* (1983), Lindner, "What Was a Nomadic Tribe?" (1982)	No pastoral economy is self-sufficient. Lindner finds the tribe was "a political organism open to all who were willing to subordinate themselves to its chief" (701)	E	4, 5	*If no pastoral formation can live on its own, how does it stay open to the sedentary world without being divided by it?*

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Other names

The names already in use, what a new name would need, and the routes one could take. Candidate words are left to the author.

Names already in use

Challenger's six others. Rhizomatics, stratoanalysis, schizoanalysis, micropolitics, pragmatics, the science of multiplicities 43

Minor science, nomad science. The science that follows its material, against royal science 361-74. It is the name of this site

Nomad thought. The title of Deleuze's 1972 talk, and of the thought set against the State form 376-80

Mobile pastoralism. What steppe research now calls the way of life once named nomadism (Humphrey and Sneath). It names an economy, not a method

What a new name would need

1. Name no people, because a people was never the root
2. Keep distribution without division, the pasture no one parcels out
3. Keep the opened unit and the local link, step by step
4. Put politics before being, as *Mille plateaux* does ("avant l'être, il y a la politique," "before being, there is politics," *Mille plateaux* 249)
5. Avoid ending in a law or a *logos*, or make that ending visible on purpose
6. Be sayable outside the university

Where one could come from

From the opened monad. Named for the local, step-by-step link that replaces the closed unit 494, 574 n. 27

From *nem-*. Named for distributing rather than dividing, with the people left out

From the method. Following, the problematic, rigor without exactness. This is closest to minor science

From Challenger's list. Take one of the aliases, or add an eighth, as the joke allows 43

Keep the name and turn it. Tell the word's own history, in which a habitat without limits was later claimed as a division

Our own observation, which Deleuze and Guattari do not make, is that "nomado-logy" puts a logos over the nomos. Plateau 12 calls this move "the triumph of the logos or the law over the nomos" 373.

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